

Win Mo ready to go
Windows 6.5 mobile handsets start lining up for release

AMD adds more cores
Six-core AMD Phenom II processors to be out sometime next year



Dirt 2 will be one of the first games to run on DirectX 11

purchasing a graphics card. I am about to buy a mid ranged graphics card in the month of September. I have read in Digit that Windows 7 is going to be released very soon and DirectX 11 games will be coming at the end of the year.

So, should I buy my graphics card in September or should I buy it after the release of Windows 7? Will DirectX 11 games have compatibility problems?

I have been reading Digit magazine for the past four months. It is a very nice magazine. Whenever I read it, I come across terms like overclocking, SLI, CrossFire, HTPC etc. I don't know what the above mentioned terms mean. Can you tell me?

Bharat Razdan

One or two DirectX 11 games might be out this year but the big lot will only come next year. It's not wise waiting for those games and then buying a DirectX 11 card. The performance of those games on mid ranged cards is yet to be seen. You can go for a sub-Rs. 10,000 card for now and then upgrading to something better when the time is right and there are plenty of DirectX 11 games around. There is no shortage of good DX9 games to play in the meantime.

Overclocking is running a component such as a processor, graphics card, and memory faster than what it's meant to. For these components, it's usually increasing the core speed or the memory speed.

SLI is a standard used by

NVIDIA based motherboards that let you use the power of two or three cards by connecting them together using a SLI-bridge. CrossFire works in the same way but is designed by AMD/ATI for their cards.

HTPC is a term used for Home Theatre PC. They are just like any other PC but they are built with low power components that require little cooling and run quiet.

Graphic card problem

I own a GeForce 8500GT graphic card. I recently installed a fresh copy of Windows XP on my PC infected with virus. I installed the drivers for the graphics card and after the reboot, it showed a black screen with the mouse pointer. I tried restarting the computer, but it shows up the same thing. Also, the audio hardware is not working, even after I installed the drivers.

Len

You could try uninstalling the drivers through the Windows Safe mode and see if it still boots up with the blank screen. Try downloading an older version of the drivers as well. Also, try using the disc that was provided to you with the card. Try the same thing with the audio hardware. You could also try using Windows Update to download the drivers for you.

DVD drive problems

My system specifications are as follows.

Processor: Intel Pentium 4 2.80 GHz
Memory: 1 GB DDR 2
Standard VGA graphics adaptor
250 GB hard drive
Moser Bear DH-22A8S DVD drive
Windows Vista Ultimate 32-bit

Over the last few days my DVD/CD ROM drive has been unable to read or write any discs. Whenever I insert a disc, the following message appears - "Insert a disc". Can you help me with this problem?

Also please suggest a 19-inch LCD monitor and a midrange graphics card for the upcoming release of Windows 7.

Bijesh

The DVD drive has most likely worn out as they often do after two years or so. You should take it over to the vendor for repair or replacement if it's still under warranty.

Look for the Samsung SyncMaster D190S and AOC F19. They should be between Rs. 6,500 and Rs. 7,500. You can easily find 22-inch monitors around Rs. 10,000 and Rs. 12,000. Your current PC will run Windows 7 just about okay. A graphics card might let you run the fancier Aero theme. Your memory is more important. Upgrading to 2 GB will help.

If you are thinking of playing some games as well, then we recommend you to upgrade your entire system. If not, a cheap GeForce 8400GS or 9400GT from Palit, Zotac or POV will be sufficient.

Laptop overheating problems

I have a Dell Studio XPS 13 (Intel 2.4 GHz, 4 GB DDR3 RAM, 320 GB hard drive) that heats up to about 79 C while playing Call

of duty 4. Is this temperature normal for a laptop? When I'm not playing and just surfing the web, the temperature stays at an average of 50C.

I've tried to overclock my fan but according to users on various forums, the PC BIOS does not permit this. I'm thinking of buying a cooling pad but are there any other solutions to cool down my laptop?

Amon Pereira

A temperature of 79 C is quite high for the laptop but as long as you're not getting stability issues, it should be okay. The only way to cool things down is to use a laptop cooler like you said. You could take the laptop to Dell and see if they can service it and clean up the insides for you. There could be a lot of dust clogged in the heat sinks or the fan might be running slower.

Registry problem

My PC configuration is as follows:
Processor: Intel 2.8 GHz Dual core
Motherboard: Intel D945,
80 GB hard drive, 1GB memory,
XFX 9400GT 512MB

I run Windows XP SP2.

Whenever I try to open up Task Manager or Registry Editor, it says that it is disabled by your Administrator! I formatted my PC twice but there has been no change in the problem. I also can't run games like Street Fighter 4 at the minimum resolution. At first, when I install the game, it runs properly but when I restart my PC, it starts giving me errors that Visual C++ has failed to load the floating module. It also happens with games like Crisis Warhead and Delta Force Xtreme 2.



Laptop coolers can help maintain temperatures